

stable feel trapped in their jobs by the high cost and risk of buying medical insurance on the open market. This is an experience unique to Americans. Many developed countries have healthcare systems as good or better than the US system. Almost all provide health care at lower costs than in the United States. People with the flexibility and means to travel can utilize medical tourism. This means traveling to foreign countries for non-emergency medical treatment. For Americans, this often means obtaining care as good as, or better than, what is available at home. It almost always means receiving care at reduced costs, even after factoring in travel expenses and paying for treatments out of pocket.

Like the other options, medical tourism has obvious drawbacks. It can work well for voluntary procedures ranging from dental care to hip replacements, but it is undesirable for someone with a serious or acute medical condition.

It's clear why many on the path to FI cite medical insurance as the biggest obstacle to achieving FI. All three of these strategies have flaws. While not perfect, they are options available to the FI community because of the choices we've made.

Health Care vs. Health Insurance